

Technical Evaluation Report

Armoured Personnel Carrier Programme — Phase II Procurement

Reference MoD/ACQ/APC-II/2026/TER-07 · Circulated to 5 recipients

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1. Scope and methodology

This report presents the consolidated findings of the Technical Evaluation Committee constituted under the Phase II acquisition programme for wheeled armoured personnel carriers. Five vendors responded to the request for proposal within the stipulated window, and all five submissions were found responsive at the preliminary scrutiny stage. The committee conducted documentary evaluation, field trials at two designated ranges, and a structured cost-realism review before arriving at the rankings recorded in the following sections.

Protection performance was assessed against the ballistic and blast thresholds specified in the qualitative requirements. Two vendors demonstrated compliance at the higher threshold without recourse to add-on armour packages, which the committee regards as materially significant given the through-life weight penalty associated with appliqué solutions. A third vendor met the threshold only in the uparmoured configuration, and the resulting mass increase pushed the vehicle beyond the stated air-transportability envelope.

2. Consolidated scoring matrix

Vendor	Platform	Protection	Mobility	Indigenous	Quoted cost
Vindhya Defence Systems	VDS-4400	78.4	82.1	71.0	Rs 3,842 cr
Kaveri Heavy Industries	KHI Rhino	81.2	74.6	79.3	Rs 4,115 cr
Aravalli Motors Ltd.	AM-Sentinel	69.8	79.2	84.7	Rs 3,690 cr
Narmada Armour Pvt.	NA-Pralay	74.1	71.8	66.2	Rs 4,402 cr
Deccan Mobility Corp.	DMC Vajra	62.3	68.4	73.9	Rs 3,510 cr

Mobility trials were conducted over graded, cross-country and gradient courses under laden conditions. The committee notes considerable divergence between declared and observed figures for two submissions, particularly in sustained gradient ascent. Where a discrepancy exceeded the tolerance band, the observed value has been carried into the scoring matrix and the vendor's declared figure has been recorded separately in the trial annexure for reference during any subsequent clarification.

3. Mobility and endurance trials

Indigenous content was verified against the submitted bill of materials and supplier declarations. The committee draws attention to the treatment of imported sub-assemblies which are subsequently integrated domestically; two vendors have accounted for the full assembled value as indigenous content, which the committee does not accept. Revised indigenous content figures, computed on the value-addition basis, are reflected in the scoring and differ materially from the declared figures in both cases.

4. Indigenous content verification

Life-cycle cost projections were normalised to a common twenty-year horizon with an assumed annual utilisation rate. The committee observes that the lowest quoted acquisition cost does not correspond to the lowest projected life-cycle cost, principally on account of divergent powerpack overhaul intervals and the availability of domestic repair infrastructure. This divergence is the single largest contributor to the reordering between the commercial and composite rankings.

The committee has considered the representations submitted by two vendors regarding trial conditions at the secondary range. Having reviewed the trial director's log and the instrumentation records, the committee is satisfied that conditions were materially comparable across all participants on the relevant days, and does not recommend a re-trial. The representations and the committee's reasoning are recorded in full in the dissent annexure appended to this report.

5. Life-cycle cost normalisation

Integration risk was assessed with reference to the programme's stated in-service date. Two submissions depend upon sub-systems that are not yet in series production, and the committee has applied a schedule-risk adjustment accordingly. The adjustment is disclosed transparently in the scoring matrix rather than embedded silently in the technical score, so that the approving authority may take a different view on risk appetite if it considers this appropriate.

In arriving at the composite ranking the committee has weighted protection and mobility parameters above commercial parameters, consistent with the approved evaluation methodology circulated prior to bid opening. No weighting was altered after the receipt of bids. The committee records that the margin separating the first and second ranked submissions is narrow, and that a reasonable difference of view on the schedule-risk adjustment could reverse that ordering.

6. Representations and dissent

The committee recommends that negotiations be opened with the first ranked vendor, and that the second ranked vendor be retained in contention pending the outcome of those negotiations. The committee further recommends that the indigenous content computation basis be clarified in writing to all vendors before any subsequent phase of this programme, so that the ambiguity identified in Section 4 does not recur.

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7. Integration and schedule risk

Protection performance was assessed against the ballistic and blast thresholds specified in the qualitative requirements. Two vendors demonstrated compliance at the higher threshold without recourse to add-on armour packages, which the committee regards as materially significant given the through-life weight penalty associated with appliqué solutions. A third vendor met the threshold only

in the uparmoured configuration, and the resulting mass increase pushed the vehicle beyond the stated air-transportability envelope.

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8. Composite ranking

Indigenous content was verified against the submitted bill of materials and supplier declarations. The committee draws attention to the treatment of imported sub-assemblies which are subsequently integrated domestically; two vendors have accounted for the full assembled value as indigenous content, which the committee does not accept. Revised indigenous content figures, computed on the value-addition basis, are reflected in the scoring and differ materially from the declared figures in both cases.

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9. Recommendation

The committee has considered the representations submitted by two vendors regarding trial conditions at the secondary range. Having reviewed the trial director's log and the instrumentation records, the committee is satisfied that conditions were materially comparable across all participants on the relevant days, and does not recommend a re-trial. The representations and the committee's reasoning are recorded in full in the dissent annexure appended to this report.

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10. Distribution

In arriving at the composite ranking the committee has weighted protection and mobility parameters above commercial parameters, consistent with the approved evaluation methodology circulated prior to bid opening. No weighting was altered after the receipt of bids. The committee records that the margin separating the first and second ranked submissions is narrow, and that a reasonable difference of view on the schedule-risk adjustment could reverse that ordering.

The committee recommends that negotiations be opened with the first ranked vendor, and that the second ranked vendor be retained in contention pending the outcome of those negotiations. The

committee further recommends that the indigenous content computation basis be clarified in writing to all vendors before any subsequent phase of this programme, so that the ambiguity identified in Section 4 does not recur.

Annexure A — Trial observations

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Annexure B — Cost normalisation working

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Annexure C — Representations received

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Annexure D — Distribution record

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